

Rep. Tom Emmer on Wake Up America

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HOST:

Capitol Hill. So before we get to this issue surrounding a central bank digital currency, I do want to get both of the reactions to last night's election results. Congressman Emmer, to you first, because it looks like the Trump endorsement is pretty telling. It should come as a surprise. Good morning.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Donald Trump is the leader of our party. He is the number one patriot. His endorsement matters. I mean, we've seen that election after election. Because of Donald Trump, you're going to have Senator Barrymore in Alabama. You're going to have Senator Mike Collins in Georgia, and you're going to have Senator Andy Barr in Kentucky. And in Kentucky, a very popular congressman is going to be replaced again because of Donald Trump's endorsement.

HOST:

Of course, turning to your home state of Texas, I don't know who we think is going to be the senator from Texas. President Trump came in, though, with a surprising endorsement of Ken Paxson for the U.S. Senate over incumbent Senator John Cornyn. So, Congressman Self, your thoughts on that? This is shaking up your home state.

REP. KEITH SELF:

Well, I think that the president has focused on the November election because I think it became increasingly obvious that Ken Paxson was going to be the nominee. And yet the narrative, and I'm not sure the narrative is right, but I think the president accepted the narrative and said, I need to get involved now in order to win the November election. Because, look, having a Democratic senator from the state of Texas would be unthinkable. It would be a tsunami across the United States. We can't have that.

HOST:

Yeah, I'm with you on that as a Texan myself. Congressman Emmer, so I know that you both have described the central bank digital currency as a surveillance tool that would work against our nation's values of liberty and financial freedom. So how could this tool be used to monitor Americans?

REP. TOM EMMER:

It's a great question. And this is legislation that I started offering about four to six years ago. Keith Self, my colleague here, has been one of the great champions on this. We don't have to guess how they would use it. All you got to do is look at the digital yuan the Chinese are already using. They surveil their citizens. They're building a scores based on your habits. What you get to buy at the grocery store, how you travel. This is the ultimate form of surveillance. And then if you believe in the greatest capital markets in the world right here in the

United States of America, a central bank digital currency will give the leftists in this country exactly what they want. Everybody will have a bank account through the Federal Reserve, and it will destroy the two tier banking system. So it's the ultimate surveillance tool that should never have a place in this country.

HOST:

Yeah, Congressman Self, I mean, you've been very outspoken on this saying it would mean, quote, no more private transactions, no more anonymous charitable donations, no more financial independence from Washington. I mean, what are you and other critics doing to stop making sure this never happens?

REP. KEITH SELF:

Well, we're continuing the fight. Look, the Senate says they will do nothing with it, but that we do not accept that we will put it on every must pass bill and make sure that with the fight continues. We haven't won in the past, but we've kept it alive because this is the ultimate. This is the third leg in the surveillance state to look. We've already got the kill switch that's coming in next year. We've already got 100,000 flock cameras across the nation. So we have a surveillance state, but we don't have the federal government having transaction into your bank account. And I think that's what Americans need to understand. The federal government could tell you you can't buy that F 3 50 pickup because they don't want you to have a diesel pickup to begin with. They want you to go electric. Or what about if you just visit a gun store? We could go on and on. But this is a pro. This will be a programmable digital currency that the federal government then be able to say you go into a gun store. We're going to turn off your bank account. Think of the Canadian truckers several years ago when they protested. What did the Canadian government do? They shut down their bank account altogether. That's what this would give the federal government, the authority and the ability to do.

HOST:

All right, Congressman Emmer, Congressman Self. Great having both of you with us this morning. Thank you, gentlemen, for taking the time to see

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